Examples: diacylglycerol, fatty acids, glycerol and cholesterol.

2.3.3 Functions of lipids:

Lipids perform several biological functions such as,

- Triglycerides serve as energy reserve of the body.
- Lipids are important components of cell membranes which regulates membrane permeability.
- Phospholipids, provide fluidity and flexibility to the cell membranes.
- Lipids act as signalling molecules.
- Fat layer provides insulation from cold.
- Lipoproteins transports lipids throughout the body.

2.4 Nucleic acids

Nucleic acids are biopolymers, essential to all known forms of life.

2.4.1 Definition

Nucleic acids are the polymers of nucleotides. Nucleotides are made of three components:

1. 5-carbon sugar
2. Nitrogenous base
3. Phosphate groups

2.4.2 Structure of nucleic acids:

Sugar unit:

If the sugar unit present in the nucleic acid is a ribose, then the polymer is called ribonucleic acid (RNA) and if the sugar is deoxyribose, then the polymer is deoxyribonucleic acid (DNA).

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